

Homework #2 Final Project

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PSYCH 201: Developmental Psych Lifespan

Sister Roberts

April 1, 2025

1. Early childhood/Preschool years - ages 2-6

Amberlyn Newman

6 years old

Gender: Female

How I Know: My cousin. Parents: Kara and Wesley Newman

1. Describe a typical day.

Go to school reading groups, read books. Go over letters. Big paper. It is hot is your favorite books. Math. Go over papers with mom. Coloring. The whole day indoor recess.

2. What activities do you enjoy most?

Coloring. Amber Lyn and a red fox inside of a cave and the sun with the light coming. Kitten. Tootles is your kitten. Oh Toodles from Mickey Mouse Clubhouse. The girls' kitty.

3. What activities do you enjoy least?

Bored and doesn't know what to do. and chores. Cleaning out kitty litter.

4. Describe your best friend. What qualities does he/she have?

Lyla. Met since birth, in school with her. Hangs out at school not as mostly. Short hair. She's nice. I don't know what else. She's a great drawer. We sit at the same table in arts.

5. What is your greatest achievement thus far in life?

I don't know. Writing notes for my family. And to my friends. Says that I love them, you have been the best friend, sister, etc. Mail station at school one for mom and one for Lyla. L Stamp on Lyla's for Lyla.

6. What is your greatest regret thus far in life?

Say I'm the worst. I forgot what I did.

7. What are you looking forward to in the near future (within the next year)?

Going to cousin's house gonna bout to go and cousin's play and sleep over @ cousin's house. I haven't seen them in a really long time and want to see Matilda again! Only one play and now I'm gonna bout to see two. Soon. Tomorrow! It's going to be so busy.

8. What are you looking forward to in the far future (5, 10, or 20 years down the road)?

When I'm 10 I'm going to do cheer or gymnastics

When I'm 15 I'm going to play the cello and be in plays because my brother is playing the cello and I've learned a little bit from him and my brother is in plays. And my brother played the boy who got his ear pulled off in Matilda. I saw my teacher at the play and her daughter was the principle.

Grownup a teacher when I'm a mom I don't know when. We did a when I grow up and I said teacher. Pig poster and pictures. A girl in my class wanted to be a fighterfighter

9. Do you have any questions for me?

How old are you? 21 is super old

After interviews did you notice anything different? I cut my hair

My brother was bald, and my dad won't grow anymore because he told me!

Makeup for Christmas + sister too and pink crocs after I said she was pretty and she said thanks. All her candies she showed me. Mini duck. Dazzling duck. Showed me that she's sleeping in her brother's tent in her room.

Analysis of a Preschooler – Amberlyn

Amberlyn is my six-year-old cousin who recently started elementary school. She is the youngest of 6 kids and in a house of mostly older brothers she is considered a princess. She loves her older siblings and wants to be like them, especially her older brother Spencer who is a sophomore in high school. She has lots of opportunities to model his behavior and interests as she's developing her own. She loves to be creative and draw her thoughts and ideas.

Her parents are very loving and firm in their expectations. They use an authoritative parenting style with her as she feels very loved and still has chores to do. Her biggest chores are taking care of the animals of the house. She shares a kitten with her older sister, and she is responsible for cleaning out the kitty litter. Although she doesn't enjoy it, she does it willingly. She feels that she is still loved and cared for despite the demands of her parents. She exhibits traits of a secure attachment style with her parents. She knows that she can go to them when she needs nurturing and support but still feels comfortable making age-appropriate decisions on her own.

Her parents are great exemplars of using process praising as she does these hard chores and works through tasks hard for a young child. This littler girl's confidence soars because of their faith and patience with her. They are good and experienced parents. Though they do engage in some person praise with Amberlyn, telling her that she's a good girl and a kind daughter, they focus more on her work ethic and actions with others.

Through her parent's recognition of her hard work on whatever she tries to do she feels that she can do anything. Her self-esteem or sense of self is very high which enables her to try all new things and keep trying. She showed me her newest drawing and called it her best one yet. I thought it was a brown rainbow, but it was actually a cave with a depiction of herself with a red

fox in with sunrays permeating the cave walls. She talked about her newest drawing as if it was her best yet, that she keeps getting better every time. She believes that she is the best drawer in her first grade. She believes the same about her reading, as she is very proficient in her reading class so far. She loves to read and utilize her imagination. Her favorite book is one she reads in her reading class called “Is It Hot?”

In her reading class she learns a lot of new grammatical concepts. The proper use of these grammar concepts is not entirely lost on her as Amberlyn learns to apply them to everyday speech. She does exercise a lot of overregularization in her speech patterns. The most prominent example from my interview with her was when she talked about the upcoming events. She kept repeating the phrase, “gonna bout to”. She added in a shortened about instead of saying I’m going to go or I’m going to go see my cousins. She also used the term fighterfighter in reference to her classmate’s career desires instead of the proper term firefighter. She would benefit from a

Amberlyn is a talkative little girl, very excitable and energetic. Amberlyn’s mother told me that she engages in private speech during her drawing activities. She talks out her thought process as she goes, walking herself through the steps of her drawing to bring her vision to life. She ends up making many intricate drawings daily. She loves the most to draw with her best friend Lyla. When they draw they are engaged in parallel play they draw side by side with little influence on each other.

Their friendship is special because they described the other in the same way. Lyla was at Amberlyn’s house during my interview, so I was able to talk to her briefly about her perception of Amberlyn and their friendship. They both said the exact same thing about why they are friends; that they met at birth and they the other is kind. Their proximal associations are key to their developing friendship. They go to school together and live in the same neighborhood. Their

families are friends. The way that Amberlyn described Kyla was with possessions and outward characteristics more than disposition. She referenced how Kyla looks and what they do together.

In describing who she wants to be she referenced her older siblings and what they do. She wants to play the cello because her brother does, it's the same for why she wants to do musical theater productions. She seems to have very little stranger anxiety and loves to show off. She even went so far as to tell me that I'm old at 21 years of age. This could be a sign of Piaget's preoperational stage of egocentrism that from her perspective 15 years is a really long time and I am therefore a very old person in her eyes. This is due to her limitations in seeing another perspective. I still feel young that I've got a lot ahead of me. Twenty-one to Amberlyn is basically a death sentence. Because she has only lived 6 years on this planet and her life right now is so exciting and new, with each year bringing many drastic changes she must be thinking that in 15 years' time she would be a complete person. I know that's how I thought at 6 years old.

2. Middle childhood - ages 7-11

Russell Nelford

Age: 8

Gender: Male

How I Know: My cousin. Parents: Beau and Stacy Nelford

1. Describe a typical day.

Chores – random chores, Living room, bathrooms, hallway, pets

Pets are Tigger, leo, mochi, neon, liam's fish – 2 turtles

Playing around friends in the neighbor.

Tues, Thurs, and Saturdays – Karate Ultimate demo team. Orange belt. Teachers have black belts with red stripes.

2. What activities do you enjoy most?

Roblox.

Karate – my teachers are fun and the kicks are fun tornado kick. Really good at it. Best in the class?

Hanging out with friends

Soaking my feet and watching alone and popped off about how great it is.

3. What activities do you enjoy least?

Hate to do nothing. Hate being bored. Never never doing something.

Body needs to move every second. Fidgeter.

4. Describe your best friend. What qualities does he/she have?

Nico wright – everyday he comes and plays with me. Roblox joins in, I'm cracked at Roblox OP. All the guns and all the zombies and sometimes skeletons.

Funny and nice he's telling funny jokes and he plays roblox whenever he dies he goes op he just died.

Met at church through siblings.

He's just awesome

5. What is your greatest achievement thus far in life?

Meet my friends. Cause they are fun. Bring so much joy to your life. Followed brother to neighbor's house.

6. What is your greatest regret thus far in life?

Having the same nightmare for 3 days in a row. Grim reaper captured by him. Terrifying and hard to sleep. Needs to soak sleep every night to help sleep and not have nightmares. White tub with water and magnesium and feet in water for 20+ minutes.

7. What are you looking forward to in the near future (within the next year)?

My birthday. July 14th. I get to go out for dinner noodles and company and airborne an indoor trampoline park.

8. What are you looking forward to in the far future (5, 10, or 20 years down the road)?

Sleep. Driving when I'm 16. Getting my own cats. 25 cats, Crazy cat gentleman.

9. What questions do you have for me?

How many pets do you want?

Analysis of a Middle-Aged Child – Russell

Russell is obsessed with his pets and with Roblox. He is a bright and interested kid who cannot stand the idea of being bored. He would feel like he's exploding if he's left with absolutely nothing to do. He hates being bored more than he dislikes doing chores. It's a good thing that he has 7 siblings who he can not only look up to but find enjoyment in their presence. Russell's family is large and rambunctious. They are also all together all day as they are a homeschooled family.

Russell is a very creative child, coming up with unique solutions that most people don't think of. Associated with his hatred of boredom, he builds new worlds in his mind and on Roblox. Roblox is his favorite game and is something he could talk about all day long. He talked about a lot of different games he plays both on his own and with his friends and siblings. He loves to engage in cooperative play through Roblox. With his best friend, Nico, Russell loves to win games with his friend and work with him to achieve goals in the different games.

Honestly, all he wanted to talk about with me was Roblox. He was clearly recently playing it as his mind was engaged in accessing and sharing his short-term memory stores. He was just working through how he would improve his gaming skills when I jumped on the interview with him. He also believes that his performance in Roblox in his eight years of age attributes to his self-concept. He wants to be better at the game so that his social status can improve for his age-bracket. All the 8-year-olds are playing Roblox and that's what they want to do when they play together. This involved a lot of social comparisons. Russell made a lot of comparisons of himself and his best friend Nico in relation to the game. Russell claims the title of the better player than Nico.

As I was talking with Russell and seeing his fixation on the game it demonstrates his attention-deficit-hyperactivity disorder. It was hard for him to “snap out” of the hyper fixation on that and into the interview. He has interesting coping mechanisms to help focus his brain and with other difficulties associated with ADHD. His parents are great at coregulation, where he gets to work on cognitive tasks with their supervision. I know he has a lot of attention-focusing activities to help him optimize his unique brain.

One of those activities that not only helps him cognitively but also to physically regulate is soaking his feet and watching his favorite television show. This show is not just an overload of senses like many kids shows today. He soaks his feet to help with nightmares. His parents are fairly homeopathic in maintaining their children’s health. Russell has seen a lot of improvement engaging in that activity and loves to talk about the health benefits he has seen with soaking his feet. He told me all about how it works and explained it as if it would be easy to do, demonstrating his perspective in that. He also described his dreams in great detail, it was as if he believed that the monster of his dream could actually affect him in real life.

Russell also engages in a lot of rough-and-tumble play with his siblings. He has many older siblings and a few younger siblings. Because he is a young boy full of energy, he loves to run around and get dirty. His athletic skills have improved a lot since his preschool years. He can run faster and throw balls around harder. In the summer his brothers are outside playing lots of hands-on sports. They love kickball, soccer, football and play all of them regularly. He’s still got a while to go to match with his older brothers who are entering adolescence, but he will get there. He loves that he gets to run around and play despite the unfair skill matchup.

His authoritative parents encourage this, allowing him to have a play-based childhood. Russell’s parents are very loving while still demanding that he prioritizes his chores around the

house. His jobs are to take care of the many animals, and he loves to do that. He asked me if I loved pets and how many I was going to have. He has at least 2 cats, a dog, and a couple turtles. He loves his cats the most and wants to be a crazy cat man when he grows up. That would be his dream for the future. He doesn't seem to care much for a house, wife, or kids in this stage of life but the nearest and dearest to his heart are the kittens and he would adopt them all if he could.

3. Adolescence - ages 12-17 (must be in junior high or high school)

Name: Sam Soelberg

Age: 16

Gender: Male

How I Know: My Brother

1. Describe a typical day.

Wake up early around 7-8am.

Come down to do stuff with the family

Do online school – taking 6 online classes. Assignment personal study quiz. Favorite class
US Government and Citizenship

Lunch

Gaming – Fortnite and Minecraft

Time with family – play with boys/take care of little kids or talk with married brother.

Soccer drills at high school because on the JV team practices everyday except the weekend

Dinner

Gaming – Fortnite and Minecraft

Bed from 11pm-12am

Worst part of day: when mom gets mad

Best part when getting to play with friends

2. What activities do you enjoy most?

Soccer, brings him peace and it's so fun. Calming to the mind and stimulating to the body.

Feels like he's really good, has good buddies.

3. What activities do you enjoy least?

Chores. My mom makes them need to be done right the first time and lots of restrictions on privileges until it gets done. No friends, phone, tech, and immediate punishment. It feels demeaning, like a little kid. Feels like he's the only one doing it all. Would rather not have immediate punishment

Dishes fully done and whatever else for the day

Take care of little brothers a lot

Has to help out with dad - man/outdoor chores

4. Describe your best friend. What qualities does he/she have?

I have 2 best friends – both are really funny

Corver, he's funny, likeable, easy to talk to, supportive, he's a good person. He wants me to grow and become better. He's shown me in multiple ways, he comes to my debate tournaments and compliment me process praise. He helped me do well in that tournament through encouragement. He helps me believe in myself.

Zoe – very sweet and kind. Makes everyone feel loved and important. She also is very supportive and helping. She is open to new ideas, a great listener and such a fun conversationalist. She's not judgmental and doesn't jump to conclusions

5. What is your greatest achievement thus far in life?

Being really good at soccer. Because although you don't start out the greatest, I've pushed really hard and put in my best effort. Going from nothing to really really good.

Good ball skills, passion and drive, ability to observe the field and make good plays.

6. What is your greatest regret thus far in life?

Having issues in younger years with kleptomania and with technology addiction. It led to many more problems even today with parents' trust.

I would go back and tell him to look ahead and think of the future, that better things would happen because of your self-restraint now.

7. What are you looking forward to in the near future (within the next year)?

Excited to improve and be on varsity next year. Lake Powell trips in the summer with the family. No school in the summer, fun camps, family reunions, all vacation trips with the family. My sister's wedding that's likely to happen in the next year.

8. What are you looking forward to in the far future (5, 10, or 20 years down the road)?

Going on a mission in the next 2 years. Getting endowed and marriage and maybe some kids but 10 years idk about that.

Excited to have a family in 10, 20 years. Having kids and a lovely wife and starting a family. I want to be an engineer.

9. Do you have any questions for me?

What is this whole thing for?

Analysis of an Adolescent – Sam

Sam is the definition of a popular-prosocial child. He is the life of the party, and everyone wants to be around him. He works hard in school and has aspirations for why he takes certain classes. This analysis from his peers is well-deserved as he is the kindest soul. He is always looking for ways to uplift others. He is a popular and well-liked team player on his high school's junior varsity soccer team. Right now, his team is doing better than the Varsity team and he is a major contributor to his team's success. He has a talent for soccer and has worked hard to develop into an awesome player. He has been playing soccer since he was about 3 or 4 years old and is the only one of his siblings to stick to a team sport for that long.

He absolutely lights up when he is process praised for his efforts in becoming a faster and stronger soccer player. Sam has become increasingly more popular since his growth spurts and other secondary sex characteristics associated with puberty. In the past year and a half, ever since about 14 years of age, he has grown a good 6 or so inches and increased in muscle mass and physical maturity. He is now the tallest sibling in his family despite being the fourth of six children and having three adult siblings. He has even started to grow the faintest little moustache on his face.

Due to the formal operations stage of Sam's development, particularly in abstract thinking and as I've seen him become more self-conscious, he has become much better at grooming due to his belief in an imaginary audience. Sam has always had great curly hair that his dad would shave off every summer and then when it would grow out to an unbearable length do the whole process over again. That is no longer the case as Sam very much cares about his beautiful curly hair, and his matters of personal choice. He now gets professional cuts and takes

care of his hair daily. It could be because of his soccer practices, but he now regularly showers too and works hard to smell good.

I've also witnessed Sam grow in personal fable as he uses the words "I don't care" a lot more when faced with consequences. He believes that the rules don't often apply to him, but he has grown a lot in that. Due to experiences in getting in trouble and the consequences of his actions facing him he employs a lot more hypothetico-deductive reasoning in a lot of actions he makes at home. He has tested the waters with his parents to see what lines could be manipulated and how far he could go to achieve his desires. He tests if he will still get to play with friends or play his games if he expresses his opinions. He has deduced that his actions in middle childhood have been detrimental to his parents' trust.

When I talked to Sam about what he wishes would be better, he had a lot of idealism-type decisions and seemed to be very critical of his parents and their decisions. He wishes his younger brothers would have more chores to do than him and wishes he had more freedom. He thinks of many ways that his parents could behave better in his mind. He is able to dream up a more "perfect scenario" for how he wants his life to be and is often critical of what isn't ideal. I remember being that way with my parents and it was only in my transition to adulthood that I was able to chill out with the comparisons and criticism of my parents.

Right now, he is in the tentative period of vocational selection. He has always been good at math and is now pursuing a career in engineering. He's not quite sure which type of engineer he wants to be but he's heading in that direction. He is a homeschooled student who takes multiple classes online. Sam has a mentor in his neighborhood that has guided him to pursue an education congruent with his interests and self-concept. His parents are great at being a secure base for him to explore from, always encouraging and pushing him to work hard at work worth

doing. He feels that he can return to his parents to additional guidance and to talk through his ideas and processes on his career-oriented academic journey.

Sam's self-concept has always been found in his membership in The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints. He values his own kindness and self-improvement. He defines himself as a son of God and a disciple of Jesus Christ. He also defines himself as a good soccer player, a great listener, and a good friend. His self-esteem has improved a lot as he's transitioned into later adolescence. He used to be down on himself as he compared himself to others but since defining his self-concept and I believe that puberty has helped him a lot with feeling better about himself.

4. Early adulthood - ages 18-40 (post high school)

Cydney Jessop

Age: 22

Gender: Female

How I Know: My Roommate

1. Describe a typical day.

Wake up from not enough hours of sleep

Get ready for the day

Eat a super small breakfast

Hours of classes

Homework at home

Hopefully take a nap

More homework

Some downtime with friends or social media

Go to bed super late and do it all again.

Best part: scripture study is the best part when I get to it. I feel spiritual strength, peace, and direction for my life. Even when things are crazy, I am still close to God.

Worst part: waking up, because of lack of sleep and feeling groggy and so angsty in the morning then I feel fine after about 5-10 minutes.

2. What activities do you enjoy most?

Rock climbing – I like feeling that I am strong and challenging myself physically. I feel accomplished because I’ve been doing it consistently for about a year now and I’ve gotten better each time I go. I like that it makes me sound more interesting since it’s a “cool hobby”.

Crocheting – I’ve enjoyed that a lot it’s a new hobby and I have gotten far on the bandana ive been working on

Hanging out with friends – my bestie. Mostly chatting and watch a movie and go rock climbing. Mostly chatting about the event of the day and the perspectives of the other. What we are learning and interesting facts. We chat a lot about the gospel and our future goals.

3. What activities do you enjoy least?

Making food when I’m hungry or doing anything while I’m hungry. I will not have enough energy to make the food and by the time the food gets done I am just upset about the whole thing.

Homework. I do like homework but hate the busywork. The busy work just wastes my time and energy and stresses me out for no reason.

I only ever dislike doing things when I’m tired and hungry. When I take care of myself, I don’t have a problem doing things.

4. Describe your best friend. What qualities does he/she have?

My bestie, mi amica mia.

We have a lot of shared values. We both love the gospel and love Jesus Christ and want to strengthen our relationships. We seek to improve ourselves and be present. We both choose to be kind and serve and learn from each other.

Communication – we both value that. Chatting is my favorite thing because I get to chat with Lexi so much.

Lexi has a good heart. Very sweet, and a good cook. She is generous and thinks of others.

Lexi supports me when I’m having a hard time and she listens to me. She comforts me and cheers me up.

She's hilarious and super-duper funny. She makes me laugh a lot and laughs at my dumb jokes too.

We quote movies all the time together.

She reads my mind.

We have been roommates for a year now after our missions and it's been the best.

5. What is your greatest achievement thus far in life?

My mission. Going on my mission and staying on my mission because I pushed myself the most I ever have in my life. Emotionally, physically, spiritually, mentally. I learned a lot about myself on my mission and I drew closer to my Savior. It gives me a reminder and assurance that I can push through things that absolutely suck and maybe have fun while doing it. I ate such good food in Italy and met such good people. I had a fantastic beautiful and wonderful experience even though it was rough.

6. What is your greatest regret thus far in life?

I don't have a lot of regrets but everything that's hard and that I could have regretted I've learned from. I might regret some trivial embarrassing moments but those aren't defining to my life.

If I could change something and learned from it more quickly would be to just view myself more positively and be more comfortable with myself. Where I'm at came through time. It took a lot of building block steps to get to where I'm at. I tried writing down the nice things people would say about me, exercising, eating healthier, and listening to the encouragement of my good friends.

7. What are you looking forward to in the near future (within the next year)?

Being an FSY councilor because I will get to share my testimony every day and get to help and encourage teenagers and serve and love them. And to do a bit of traveling and make dollars. I feel that I have things to share from what I've learned with the rising generation.

8. What are you looking forward to in the far future (5, 10, or 20 years down the road)?

Getting espoused. Find a good young man to get married to and to also pursue my education and career as a marriage and family therapist.

I'm looking for an emotionally intelligent man. Someone I can be very comfortable with who I can be myself with being a little bit silly. Someone who can make me laugh and be lighthearted but also who can be serious and have important conversations. Someone who will prioritize me and I him.

I want to be a MFT. I realized I like to talking to people about their problems and maybe wanted to be a mental health councilor but on my mission and seeing quality families and marriage and I knew that I wanted to help the fundamental unit to society in that way. My family has been an amazing blessing to me and I want to extend that to others.

9. Where do you spend most of your time?

In homework. Most of my time is sucked away to homework. I'm taking more credits than I should and working. Lots of writing this semester.

10. In what aspect of your life do you catch yourself comparing the most?

Probably just the stage of life that I'm in. My friends are getting married or are married and it's easy to compare my life to theirs because I'm single. Intellectually I compare to others with grasping concepts and how well I'm handling my stressors.

Analysis of a Young Adult – Cydney

Cydney Jessop is a kind-hearted and generous soul. She is my best friend and I am blessed to write this analysis about her. Cydney is the oldest daughter in her family with an older married brother. She has 4 younger siblings and absolutely adores her family. Her family life has been very typical and helped Cydney grow to become a healthy and secure child. She regularly communicates with her family, receives a lot of support from them and encouragement to be on her own and work towards her career and family goals while in college. In periods of transition between semesters and employment opportunities, Cydney returns home and always knows she has a place with her family.

Her family is a secure base for her as she moves through her identity achievement phase. She has decided to become a Marriage and Family Therapist. She described that she decided on that career when synthesizing her abilities and desires to help others with the need she saw for healthy families. Being blessing with a loving family with authoritative parents helped her a lot in her decision to pursue this career. Their love and yet firm expectations for her life helped her to feel confident that she can confide in them with anything. She also feels confident enough to not be stuck in any sort of learned helplessness. She knows that with enough effort she can achieve her goals.

The past couple of years have been interesting for Cydney. Ever since she began the first stage of the family life cycle, moving out for college, she has become increasingly aware of the social clock and it happening to those around her. Her brother who is only a couple years older than her got married last year and most of her closest friends are married. Cydney is feeling left behind because she doesn't yet have a significant other. This is often a difficult perspective to have as many social comparisons are made. She views herself and

achievements in relation to others. Now, Cydney is generally quite happy and content with her life but that longing for an “eternal companion” is strong, stronger still with others living a part of her dream.

Cydney’s dream is very typical of a woman. Not only does she have career goals of becoming a Marriage and Family Therapist, but she also wants a family and to build a life with her eventual spouse. She seeks to model the behavior of her parents. A simple life, a loving home, children, and safety and security within the home. Her self-concept is rooted in achieving her religious goals. As a member of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, Cydney’s moral identity is defined in her faith in Jesus Christ. A large part of her identity is keeping the Lord’s commandments and that is why her focus on helping others in her career and having a family are central to her self-concept.

Cydney prioritizes her health and wellness. She loves to exercise and improve her nutrition habits. She has better self-esteem as she improves her physical health. She has a positive mood and better overall health as she exercises at the recommended 150 minutes a week. This helps her become a better student, get better rest, and promote wellness overall.

I have always considered Cydney to be a mature thinker, she hasn’t readily accepted what she’s been given at face value. Therefore, she has transcended dualistic thinking. She also has gone beyond tolerance of individual truths and has synthesized her own perspective. She is now in commitment within relativistic thinking where she is eager to learn and add to what she concretely believes. She is open to new perspectives while working on her own.

I think of Cydney as a hardy person. One who is committed, loves a challenge, and realizes her control over the situations of her life. She builds the scope of her abilities to be able to take on new tasks. She has a healthy blend of emotion-centered and problem-focused

coping. She discusses her thoughts and feelings, often with me, and in her journal. We discuss what happens in our classes and our interactions with others. This is very helpful for when we can't do much about the situation directly. When Cydney is coping to problem-centered coping it often involves her self-conscious emotions. She builds solutions and seeks support in those. She mostly works to take care of herself, good sleep, eating food, and exercise. These directly affect her self-image and regulate her emotions of envy or comparisons.

These actions stave off burnout and help her to stay on track with her goals while navigating college. There are so many things to think about and it's stressful. She works hard to take control of her life. She makes time for important relationships and for homework. Homework isn't often fun, especially when it's busy work but she handles it like a champion. I am really proud of her and I look up to her a lot.

5. Middle adulthood - ages 41-64

Beau Nelford

Age: 43

Gender: Male

How I Know: My uncle.

1. Describe a typical day.

Woken up with little babies coming into room. Boys finding sugar and screaming

Read scriptures in morning with fam

Workout or go to office to start early meetings

Work a bunch – a consultant at Angle point. Help companies get more out of cloud computing. Was an engineer before so this is way different and lots of fun. Interacting with huge companies fortune 100s. About 9 months of working. After running own business.

Stop for lunch or have lunch with fam

Work late until 6 or 7

At my family's beck and call after that to clean or put babies to bed, take kids around, make dinner.

2. What activities do you enjoy most?

Like fixing stuff - messy room clean, cleaning up workout room, just wants to look at it now.

Working with hands, being a handyman. childhood on Legos and now the world is a big lego set. As an engineer how do you fix it out. It's not typical to fix things and not just throw it away in capitalism. It's not broken unless I can't fix it.

Hanging out with family is super fun but not always sometimes they are cranky.

Music and concerts. Play the guitar a bunch.

3. What activities do you enjoy least?

Playing board games. Card games. Mother ruined it for him. If gammy lost then she would accuse you of cheating so she took all the fun out of it. Gammy has a lot of narcissistic tendencies. She had to win and she had to be right, the world was black or white, you couldn't have your own opinion. Lots of little things, fish discover water last. People should be able to build you up. She needed us to perform rather than supporting her kids. Maybe I'm an accidental byproduct that turned out okay after crazy parents.

4. Describe your best friend. What qualities does he/she have?

Stacy my wife

To me she is the kindest and most graceful person I've ever met

So caring and so genuinely good.

Wants to serve and help and love others.

She had a homeschool group to help our families.

She knows how to help people feel good

Every promotion I got was from talking to her and discussing with her and acting on her advice

She is incredibly wise intuition and something I trust more than my own thoughts

Naturally talented and wise

Being around her makes me better in all the ways. And I want to be better.

She doesn't know how amazing she is. She is blind to her strengths. I remind her of those strengths and how amazing she is.

5. What is your greatest achievement thus far in life?

Aside from marrying Stacy is the most important decision I've ever made. Noticing the way, I was different with her. I was changed by her aura. The way that I felt when I was with her. I like who I am and how I feel. She was funny and wacky and athletic. She is sensitive to how I'm feeling. 6 weeks from dating to propose and 6 months until married. Nothing else has eternal significance.

6. What is your greatest regret thus far in life?

Spent a lot of time chasing validation in life. If I could go back to 12 and 13 hey, you're a good kid and everything will be all right. Chased relationships for validation. Sports to be noticed by narcissistic parents. Could have avoided a lot of heartburn and improved a lot of relationships by being less self-centric. Missed out on good relationships with guys. Took me a long time to realize that guys were messing with me because they liked me. Was a very sensitive kid and took a lot of things seriously, was the guy who couldn't take a joke. Wish that sooner that I had realized.

Wish I was there more mentally and emotionally.

Took learning motivations and what am I doing, realizing more about myself. Only 2 years ago realized I have clinical major depressive disorder. Family has strong connection to autism and adhd, why have I felt like a failing parent for my kids' issues. Oh there is really mental health challenges here. It has become less of how am I failing and more of adjusting to be understanding of the way that they think. I haven't stopped learning but I haven't been ready to learn things about myself. Some terrifying realizations of I am not being who I think I am being.

It took a long time to realize that I need grace and grace from the Savior to give to others. Empathy isn't acquired when you realize that you need the Savior. I see that others might need some grace. Shared joy is double joy, shared sorrow is half the sorrow.

7. What are you looking forward to in the near future (within the next year)?

2 thoughts:

Stacy and I won a cruise and we've never been so that will be fun to be alone after about 4-5 years. Either Caribbean or Bahamas or Gulf of America.

Work there is confidence building I get to sell x company.

Relationship

Home and work stuff

8. What are you looking forward to in the far future (5, 10, or 20 years down the road)?

Hoping to see my kids launch successfully into their own lives and see their successes.

School marriage jobs, especially for my girls. Help them in their successes. I'm excited for them to succeed and watch them develop into adults and grown women. I don't have a script for them. Watch them become who they are. LeBron James with his kids.

9. What questions do you have for me?

No questions.

Analysis of a Middle Adult – Beau

Beau Nelford is a very kind man who has come from some really rough situations. He has chosen to be kind and respectful despite his upbringing which demonstrated the exact opposite. His parents were both awful to each other and to their kids. Those parents were narcissistic and self-centered. This led to their divorce when Beau was only 4 years old. The domineering and controlling environment that his parents provided as authoritarian parents produced in him an extra sensitivity to criticism and affected all of his relationships.

My mother was just a few years older than Beau and went through all of this with him and more. His perception of her growing up was not always positive. The sibling rivalry was huge, and they butted heads like no other. He realizes now how much she was trying to shield him from the awful experiences their parents put them through. He has had to grow a lot to not view himself according to his achievements in order to receive validation.

When it was time for Beau to move out and go on his mission, he learned a lot about relationships and that helped him prepare for his marriage to his sweetheart Stacy. He thinks very highly of her and has built a wonderful life with her. He is in the third stage of the family life cycle and has eight children with Stacy. They have a loving family and a wonderful home environment. Their children have a safe place to grow and learn together. Despite many learning difficulties in their family Stacy and Beau are pillars of strength.

They live in a traditional marriage. He is the working provider, and she mainly nurtures the kids and stays home with them. This dynamic has worked well for their family. Stacy has homeschooled their kids and even built a group for other homeschooling moms to thrive in. Beau has been so supportive of her throughout all of that. Although Beau is mostly in charge of bringing in the income, he also spends a lot of time at home with the kids. They have built

systems that work for them and their family in sharing responsibilities. Beau is very supporting of Stacy, and she does the same for him. They are excellent at coparenting. They will never dog on the other for the parenting techniques employed.

Beau is full of creativity. He graduated with a linguistics degree and has pursued information technologies since. He loves making new and exciting hobbies. He has always been this way, and his kids take after him. Every time I meet with him he's learning something new or practicing a new hobby. He is a life-long learner and loves to come up with new and diverse ways of completing his tasks.

He is very divergent in his thinking for this. Although he is an IT guy nothing stops him from fixing things with his hands. He almost never has a manual for anything and loves to find a way to fix it. Only if he can't fix it is it actually broken. With himself he has been working to fix his traumas. He uses recognition when there are situations familiar to his childhood that he needs to work on. He wants to do better for his kids but also for everyone he associates with.

He realizes that although it was unfair what happened to him in his childhood and that it is largely his parents' fault, he takes responsibility for who he is now. When he was younger, he regretted holding in so much hostility and anger. Now he is able to think about the past with a positivity effect. He can see where others were trying to help him and the good that surrounded him. He mentioned a lot of times in his earlier years where he would use emotion-centered coping to indirectly deal with his personal problems. He would spend a lot of time avoiding the confrontation with himself.

Now, Beau is becoming an expert in problem-focused coping. He knows that he will probably not repair his relationship with his parents but that he can repair his relationship

with himself. His wife Stacy is his biggest supporter and he gushes about her in the sweetest way. He talked a lot about how they build each other. He shared with me some of the ways she struggles with her self-esteem and how he helps her through that. They are such an amazing example to me of how I want my marriage to be.

6. Late adulthood - age 65+

Ida Lyn Soelberg

Age: 75

Gender: Female

How I Know: My grandmother.

1. Describe a typical day.

It's amazing how busy you can be at 75. I have friends my age that say the same thing. They are surprised how busy you can be. Today I'm taking a meal in to my friend who I minister to that has breast cancer. While I'm fixing food I'm thinking of another friend who's only 50 and is on kidney failure and I'm thinking of what I can share with her.

I'm making bread, pies, salad, and meatloaf. I'm making a berry pie for them because they love that.

Exercise class twice a week. Fit n fall. It's so you don't fall so I didn't go while I was visiting family and evidently I got to stick with it.

Sewing and making quilts

Doing family history.

Kristie's kids started tennis, and I go to their matches and I guess soccer also started.

Everyday something different is going on.

Orchestra concert Lacie, big musical coming up

Next week to Redeemer with Marcy Jenny Oaks Baker concert.

Temple on Tuesdays

Church on Sundays

Going to Boise tomorrow to visit the kidney failure friend

Deseret book, Costco, quilt shop.

Lots of outside work to do at this time of the year.

Kristi's kids are coming next weekend because her brother-in-law is the new Rome temple mission president

I have to keep my schedule busy with all of the things

Down to Utah in April for grandson's baptism

With 10 kids there's always stuff to do

I do sit down in the evenings and sometimes I watch the news and sometimes I don't want to watch the news. Watch a movie and crochet. I can't just sit and just sit y'know you have to do something.

It drove my grandma who lived to be 101 that ladies would just sit around. She said you need to get up off your duff and get moving. She trained me what to do.

2. What activities do you enjoy most?

The temple. Best day of the week. Now I'm going to cry of course. I love the spirit there and the peace and I like to think that I'm close to grandpa (passed away less than 3 years ago). I have some really good friends there. I'm a sealing floor coordinator. I get to know a lot of people. Extra special things like building referrals

9th year of temple worker. It doesn't feel like 9 years but yeah that's the best thing.

It really is the place to be, and I've been trying to go another day in the week to get my own work done.

Next favorite thing is between cooking and sewing and you can always cook but you've got to have someone to cook for and sewing is limited too.

I learned how to be a good cook from my mom and grandma. Became a cook when parents got divorced. A sweet home teaching coupled gave me a cook. If you have the right recipe anyone can cook. I gathered recipes so I could cook throughout my life.

3. What activities do you enjoy least?

Grandpa loved to work outside, and I never did that because he was always doing that. That used to be my least favorite but now I do like it and to watch things grow.

I don't know my least favorite

I always wanted to be a wife and mother and that's all I really wanted to do and that's what I like doing. So I can't think of anything I really don't like to do. Maybe later but not now.

I like cleaning and cooking and taking care of kids and whatever.

4. Describe your best friend. What qualities does he/she have?

Jeanie Johnson – have a lot in common in that we are converts to the gospel both grew up in PNW and both picked strawberries and berries. Our mothers liked to cook, and Jeanie likes to cook. We've taught cooking and pie classes together. She likes to sew and wuilt so we go shopping for quilts together. We go to lunch together once a month with other ladies. Our kids grew up together. We live in a garden spot. What we do together is pick apples and can them together. Peaches, apples, berries. Potatoes fields, onions together. We like to harvest and do that together. We don't want to just buy a box we want to pick the fruit too or it's not fun.

She has a strong testimony of the gospel; she is really solid in that. She and I will take food into people. We make baby quilts together as an assignment in the church.

She has a big and giving heart. She likes to do things right. She's a perfectionist. Quality is important but she's also really frugal. We get a kick out of finding deals together.

5. What is your greatest achievement thus far in life?

Probably 10 kids. I didn't decide to have 10 kids. But the kids just kept coming and grandpa and I both like kids and I talked to one of my mentors in our ward a sweet lady who had 8 kids and back then I had 4. She said it was 8 kids and that's all she could have. I thought that 8 was a lot so I realized that God would send you all the kids you need and will have. My kids call me naïve.

I was called to be RS president when I was pregnant with my 8th child. There was a time where I got really worried about this baby I was carrying, and I don't know why but I'm worried about her. I got a blessing from bishop and grandpa. She was born a girl but blessed as if it was a boy. I was worried about Kristi because I needed that blessing for my next boy and the last was a bonus. We are blessed with 10 children. A big family is a big blessing.

Cousins are connections everywhere you go.

6. What is your greatest regret thus far in life?

I think my greatest regret is that we didn't figure out a way to have more family activities, vacations, whatever. Grandpa worked 6 days a week all his life. I wish we had more family time even though he was home every single night it seemed like it was all work and no play. I would have liked more family fun time.

Somehow I would have talked grandpa into not working so much I guess and actually plan to have family fun. It wasn't just going to happen on its own it has to be planned out. My part would be making a plan and just hoping that grandpa would be there. It would always be more fun with him. Trips was usually a quick trip to visit family and hurry back to work. I could have done more on my part. Coulda/shoulda/woulda. We could have planned things as a family, family councils to get ideas.

Thankfully our kids take care of and join in the family reunions now. Spending a week or so every year to get together. I want my grandchildren to know each other and that's tricky if you don't see each other often. I like that we do them in different places to see other things. Nauvoo was such a fun trip.

7. What are you looking forward to in the near future (within the next year)?

Bryson's wedding.

Devon's medical school graduation and will then have a 3-year residency and be considered a doctor.

Tate's baptism in April

Micah's baptism in October

That's about all I have

8. What are you looking forward to in the far future (5, 10, or 20 years down the road)?

Lexi getting married

Lizzie getting married

Markel and Halle getting married

9. What is the most important piece of advice you would give me now?

You can live about the same with 2 people as 1 and it is what the Lord wants. Marriage isn't too financially hard.

Stay true to the gospel and as far as marriage goes, marry someone who's equally grounded in the gospel. I used to tell your dad and his siblings.

Find someone who will make a good father or make a good mother, and you will have a happy marriage. Don't look for who makes you happy. You are creating a family. Find someone who will be good to your children. Find someone who is solid. True to who they are.

The Lord has a way of blessing you when you are doing what's you're supposed to and marriage is one of those supposed to dos.

10. How does it feel to be 75?

It doesn't feel a whole lot different except I had a fall the other day and now I feel like I'm 75. Going to get haircut after spending 2 weeks with a son. Indoor and outdoor shoes tiptoes on the carpet and then got caught on the toes on my shoes tripped into wooden couch and hit sternum which I guess it's better than hitting your head. Now I'm walking slower and feeling like I'm actually 75. When you get 75 your bones aren't as good, and your bones could break. It was a painful fall. It will take 4-6 weeks before it stops hurting. Still very active. Aleive helps with pain. Happened a week ago. The prayers never stop.

Analysis of a Late Adult – Lyn (Grandma)

Lyn is the most angelic person I know. She is so kind-hearted and can't help but crying when she talks about God or her family. She has the most loving temperament. Her faith is the most powerful thing I can think of. This woman could literally move mountains no problem. Her faith has helped her with her grief at the passing of my grandfather and her life companion of 50 years. When my grandfather passed away in June of 2022, we were all struck by the suddenness of his passing, especially for my grandmother. I have been impressed by her strength in getting through all of that. She still refers to him as if he is there.

Lyn and Blaine have 10 kids, my father is the fourth. I have been blessed by my associations with Lyn my whole life. Although Lyn loves to get her family together, she is often not the kin keeper. Her kids take on that responsibility and are great at gathering their families together and the family reunions are huge. We have family reunions every year, either in the summer or for the holiday season. It's wild to get so many of us together. Our family reunions are about 70 people large.

Lyn rejoices in her posterity, and she makes time for all of us. I really don't know how she does it. Her calendar is always super full of events every day. No problems with prospective memory because she keeps a calendar very well. She remembers every detail of the events of the year. She immediately writes down when an event is shared and somehow with her grandma skills makes it to every important event of her grandchildren. She does something every single day to be there for her grandkids.

Her aspirations are in her children and grandchildren. Before my grandfather passed away, my grandma and him recorded a video for their posterity. They shared their values and aspirations for eternity with us. They demonstrated generativity where they felt that in their

more than seventy years of experience, they had a lot to pass down. It was beautiful to hear their faith for us. They want all of us to make it home with them. That they want no empty chairs in heaven. They shared with us their most important values and I cherish that video and the continued action of my grandmother's faith that I get to witness.

For my whole life I've known my grandma to be basically blind. She would never drive the car and now that she has to (though she avoids it if anyone else can drive) her lack of vision is a little scary. Almost her whole life she has had myopia and has worn glasses to correct her near-sightedness. As her age progressed so has her vision impairments. Her presbyopia has led her to need to wear 2 sets of contacts. She can't even see out of her glasses very well. She puts on one set of soft contact lenses and another hard, glass-like set on top of the soft contacts just so she can see.

Besides the vision my grandma has had very successful aging. She is strong and active, and she is not overweight or obese. She takes a fitness class twice a week specifically designed to help elders not fall. That, however, did not stop the fall that she had just a couple weeks ago. She said that after her fall it was the first time that she actually felt 75 years old. She is aware that her bones are not as strong and that the risk of injury is great. She is anticipating a full recovery from sternum bruising but has become more cautious and treads more carefully now.

When my grandparents entered their third age which came a little bit later into their sixties because they still had a child at home, they went all into service. They are definitely high in self-efficacy. My grandparents had been saving their whole lives to serve a mission for The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints. When their last son went on his mission they immediately packed up and left. They served a faithful mission in the Navajo

reservation in Chinle, Arizona and returned to continue to by Pathways missionaries and serve in various callings and as temple workers in their Meridian Idaho temple.

This demonstrated their selective optimization with compensation where they selected to do only their most favorite tasks. Now my grandmother loves to stay busy, so she visits family and attends the grandkids' soccer games. She also serves her friends and said that she loves to cook but you have to have someone to cook for. In her downtime she will watch some shows or the news but keeps her hands busy and crochets during all of it. My grandpa was always the one taking care of the lawn and now my grandma loves it. She loves to spend time in the sun and gardening. She is living such an idyllic life in the outskirts of Boise. Her home is always filled with love and light and usually lots of little kids.

Conclusion

Talking with the kids I was reminded of what it's like to be a kid again. I appreciated their enthusiasm and energy. I thought a lot about how limited the cognitive capacity of kids is in comparison to their parents, my grandmother, or even the teenager. They just view themselves as the center of the world and that their preoccupations are the most prevalent stressor in their lives. At the same time, I was incredible impressed with how well they were functioning, not only cognitively but emotionally and physically. Sometimes I undermine the validity of children's emotions and experiences. I think to myself 'well, I made it through that stage so everything you are experiencing isn't nearly as valid as my current experiences where everything is so much bigger.' I have way more to think of than these children who are perfectly cared for by loving parents. It shows how limited my own views are. How I think of the younger generation.

Maybe it's because I've always felt a little bit uncomfortable in how to act around people I don't understand. Me feeling so removed from the younger generation made me very conscious of how I interact with them. I remember how impactful positive interactions were with other people when I was younger. Their encouragement and positive regard helped me so much. I model that behavior that I remember in my youth with how I communicate with the younger kids. I carried that into talking with my little brother.

I have watched Sam grow up. I remember almost his entire life. He is 6 years younger than me and so much of his crucial growing period into adolescence happened while I was on my mission. He was 13 years old when I left and just a month ago, he turned 16. I have watched him mature into a kind and intelligent young man. I love to see where he's turning his life to and how he's thinking about the future. I am so happy that he is finding joy in the

little aspects of life as well as gaining a greater perspective on everything. He is considering his relationships and making time for what's important. I love seeing him reflect on his life experiences, where he sees his own growth. Right when I was his age Covid shut down a lot of things and I felt that a lot of my emotional maturity was stunted and delayed. I am just now facing my demons and learning from my life's ups and downs.

Talking with Cydney, who is my best friend, helped me draw in what stage of life I am in. When she talked about what she's looking forward to in the near and far future I got so excited with her. In the same stage of life that we are in we are finally able to realize the dreams of childhood. Sam talked about how he was excited to pursue an engineering career and marry a good woman. Now is the time in my life where I can synthesize those exact dreams. I am pursuing an education leading me to my dream career and I am so close to the second stage of the family life cycle.

I know from my experiences with Beau and Grandma Soelberg that the fulfillment of creating and maintaining a family must be the most joyful part of the lifespan. Sure, it's got to be the hardest part of life as well, but the true happiness and fulfillment makes it all worth it. Beau taught me a lot about finding inner peace, reconciling oneself to hard times in the past so that the present and future can be better. His biggest regret was putting off the facing himself and his preconceived notions. He would have had better relationships if he had realized his sensitivities sooner. Since he has, all his relationships have improved. He chooses to be intentional.

Intentionality is also what my grandma talked about. She doesn't regret much, she doesn't regret living frugally or having ten kids. She does regret not planning more family activities while her kids were home. I think the Lord makes up for what we can't because my

whole life I have been blessed to attend Soelberg family reunions which have always been so fulfilling to my life. My parents, aunts and uncles have taken on the responsibility of gathering the whole family together. I have been so blessed by the generations of good people that have taken care of me.

Beau and Lyn made me very excited for a committed marriage which they both have. Beau talks about his wife Stacy as if she's the best thing to ever happen to him. He talks about growing up together and healing traumas neither of them caused. My grandmother talks about my late grandfather in the sweetest way. She spent 50 years with him before he passed and it's like he's still right there with her. Her celestial view helps with that so much as well as her temple attendance. She says she imagines him right there with her. They spent years serving in the temple on the same shift together.

I want a love like that. That would be my dream for the next 5, 10, and 20 years. I want to be able to bring children into the world who have such a limited capacity not only mentally but physically. I am excited to see them grow and develop into capable and strong adolescents who are able to dream big and work towards their goals. When those kiddos grow up enough to make their own decisions for where their life goes, I want them to feel safe enough to return to me in their transitionary periods. I hope they get to live as I do, with the realization of dream just around the corner. When they have their own kids, I hope to share with them what I've learned throughout my life and with my experiences. The joys of life that my Heavenly Parents have given me are so precious. I want to take advantage of it all and rejoice in my posterity.